was for him to consider the proposal. Parekh felt flattered but without a moment's hesitation said that he was not interested in leaving ICICI even for a higher position, as he derived great job satisfaction from his job. He met Bhattacharyya and thanked him for his offer and for the confidence reposed in his abilities but declined the offer. It was a decision that Parekh would never regret despite some of his well-wishers telling him that he had missed out on a golden opportunity.[29]

Building Expertise

With its ever widening horizon of development, ICICI was never content to merely confine itself to lending activity. It was always aware that much of real development is intangible and in keeping with this philosophy, improvement of technical and professional skills through training attracted ICICI's attention from its early years. Whether it was in-house training for its staff, training outside ICICI, or sending its middle and senior level officers abroad for training, ICICI did all it could to build up expertise which would ultimately be valuable to it in the discharge of its increasingly complex task.

ICICI also endeavoured to inform public opinion in a variety of ways. To understand its clients better and to improve communication with them, ICICI organized seminars which set a precedent which others later adopted. This helped to bring the borrower closer to the lender and gave a better insight to the lender into the needs and difficulties of its clients. ICICI also invited industry experts, professionals, economists and government officials, for which basic studies and papers were prepared in ICICI. Its experiences with industry resulted in accumulation of a great deal of expertise which it disseminated by establishing a tradition of publishing monographs and studies based on its experiences.

ICICI also promoted in 1970, the Institute for Financial Management and Research at Madras. In 1965, it instituted an Annual Training Programme, under which two nominees of other developing countries of Asia and Africa were invited every year to spend two months in India for management training in development finance.[30] As one of the older development banks, ICICI also began to take an increasing interest in developing relations with other development banks in India and abroad. It organized a regional